

Muhammad Rafay Waqar

[linkedin.com/in/rafaywaqar](https://www.linkedin.com/in/rafaywaqar) | +1 (530) 608-4289 | rafaywaqar2004@gmail.com

SUMMARY

Policy analyst with hands-on experience at the IMF and World Bank Group, specializing in macroeconomic research, stakeholder engagement, and policy analysis for MENA and South Asian constituencies. Published author of op-eds and features on political economy and international affairs in national newspapers. Multilingual communicator with a global perspective, pursuing a career in geopolitical risk, AI governance, and policy research.

EDUCATION

B.A. in Political Science · Minor in Technology Management

Class of 2026

University of California, Davis

EXPERIENCE

Economic Analyst Intern (Visitor) - International Monetary Fund, Washington DC

Aug – Sep 2024

- Conducted macroeconomic and financial policy analysis for the OEDMD constituency (Algeria, Ghana, Iran, Libya, Morocco, Pakistan, Tunisia), preparing impact assessment briefs to support IMF Executive Board deliberations across 7 member countries
- Worked under the Executive Director and Senior Advisor; selected through the competitive UC Washington Program — one of few undergraduates placed at a multilateral institution

Policy Research Intern - The World Bank Group, Washington DC

Jul – Aug 2024

- Supported the Executive Director's office by analyzing policy reports and drafting strategic content for work programs spanning 8 MENA countries
- Developed fact sheets and sectoral strategy input for MENA country programs; conducted targeted research for the Pakistan Country Strategy Framework 2024

International Student Representative - ASUCD, UC Davis, Davis, CA

May 2024 – May 2025

- Elected to represent 6,000+ international students; secured funding for multiple RSOs, championed student rights through structured advocacy, organized cross-cultural panels, workshops, and cultural events to amplify international student voices, and facilitated direct dialogue between students and university administration

MENASA Resources Community Organizer - UC Davis, Davis, CA

Oct 2023 – Jul 2024

- Planned and executed 15+ community events including speaker series, cultural nights, workshops, and panels, engaging 50 students per event; developed digital outreach strategies and established organizational partnerships to strengthen community infrastructure across MENASA student communities

Business & Economics Research Intern - SouthAsia Magazine (Hybrid), Lahore, Pakistan

Dec 2023 – Jan 2024

- Researched and reported on international business news, financial trends, and political-economic developments across South and Southeast Asia for feature stories and analysis pieces
- Conducted data analysis on macroeconomic developments and trade dynamics, translating complex financial information into accessible editorial content for a broad readership, and maintained editorial accuracy through rigorous fact-checking and copy-editing across print and digital formats

Policy Intern - CoRe Alliance (Pakistan's first packaging recycling alliance), Washington DC

Jul – Sep 2023

- Prepared policy briefs on circular economy frameworks and conducted research on the emerging UN global plastic treaty and potential institutional partnerships. Developed a legal roadmap for establishing the Alliance's first international office in Washington D.C., analyzing regulatory requirements and strategic partnership opportunities.

Founder Water4Pakistan, Lahore, Pakistan

2019 – 2022

- Founded a social media advocacy platform to raise awareness about water conservation and pollution in Pakistan across Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter and crowdfunded \$5,000 to support clean drinking water initiatives for school-going children in rural Punjab

SELECTED WRITING · OP-EDS & FEATURES

Published 12+ op-eds in The News International, The Express Tribune, and Dawn on political economy, international affairs, and social policy (2018–present).

- Economic Agenda — The News International: <https://www.thenews.com.pk/print/1280799-economic-agenda>
- Governing AI — The News International: <https://www.thenews.pk/print/1415881-governing-ai>
- Ukraine: Global Food Security — The News International: <https://www.thenews.com.pk/print/987812-global-food-security>
- Genocides' Unseen Epidemics — The Express Tribune: <https://tribune.com.pk/story/2462270/genocides-unseen-epidemics>
- Tackling Plastic — The News International: <https://www.thenews.com.pk/print/1045208-tackling-plastic>

SKILLS

Policy Analysis · Economic Research · Report Writing · Statistical Analysis (R) · Stata · Power-BI · Python · SQL · Tableau

LANGUAGES

English, Urdu, Punjabi, Hindi (Native) - French, Persian (Basic)